

The Apex Archive — Store Owner Handoff Checklist

1. Confirm your Shopify login

- ☐ You already have a Shopify account — just send me the email address it's under, so I can add you to the store and start the ownership transfer.

I use your account's email to send the staff invite and transfer ownership to you.

2. Accept the store

- ☐ Accept the **staff invite** email from Shopify.
- ☐ Accept the **ownership transfer** — this makes you the official store owner.

once you're the owner, the money, taxes, and account are all in your name (not mine).

Keeping me on (so I can help you): after the transfer I'll stay on your store as a staff member — or set up free **collaborator access** through my Shopify Partner account — so I can jump in whenever you need changes. Just keep me added / approve the access request; you can remove it anytime.

3. Put your billing on the account

- ☐ **Settings** → **Plan** → confirm the plan and add **your** payment method (card).

Why: the monthly Shopify subscription bills the owner — that's you now.

4. Turn on payments

- ☐ **Settings** → **Payments** → **Activate Shopify Payments** → enter your business info, tax ID, and **bank account** (this is where your sales money is deposited).
- ☐ (Optional) Add **PayPal** as a second checkout button.
- ☐ (Optional) Toggle on **Shop Pay / Apple Pay / Google Pay** and **Shop Pay Installments** (buy-now-pay-later).

Your payment options:

Option	What customers can use	Rough cost
Shopify Payments (main)	All major cards + Shop Pay + Apple/Google Pay	~2.4–2.9% + 30¢ per sale
PayPal (optional)	PayPal balance + PayPal-processed cards	~3.49% + 49¢ per sale

Recommended: turn on Shopify Payments as your primary, and add PayPal as a backup button.

5. Set your store email to ApexCardArchive@gmail.com

- ☐ **Settings** → **Notifications** → **Sender email** → enter ApexCardArchive@gmail.com.
- ☐ **Open the ApexCardArchive@gmail.com inbox and click the verification link Shopify sends you.** The email address will **not** start working until you click that link.
- ☐ **Settings** → **Store details** → **Store contact email** → set the same address.

*this is where your Contact form and Custom Order form submissions are delivered.
(Newsletter / "Join our email list" signups don't go to an inbox — they show up automatically in your Customers list inside Shopify.)*

6. Connect your domain — TheApexArchive.com

Your domain is registered at **GoDaddy**, so the DNS changes happen there.

- ☐ In Shopify: **Settings** → **Domains** → **Connect existing domain** → enter theapexarchive.com.
- ☐ In **GoDaddy** → **Manage DNS**, set these records (delete any old parking/forwarding records that conflict):
 - **A record** — Host @ → 23.227.38.65
 - **AAAA record** — Host @ → 2620:0127:f00f:5::
 - **CNAME record** — Host www → shops.myshopify.com
- ☐ Back in Shopify → **Verify connection** (usually works within a couple hours, up to 48).
- ☐ Set theapexarchive.com as your **primary domain** and turn on "**Redirect all traffic to this domain.**"

Why: this makes your store load at your own web address, with a secure padlock (Shopify adds the SSL certificate automatically).

7. Go live

- ☐ **Online Store** → **Preferences** → **uncheck the password protection** when you're ready for real customers.

8. Test before you announce it

- ☐ Visit **https://theapexarchive.com** — it loads with a padlock (secure).
 - ☐ Build a cabinet → **Add to cart** → check out → confirm the price is correct. Place one small **test order**, then **refund** it from the Orders page.
 - ☐ Submit a quick **test message** through the Contact form → confirm it arrives at ApexCardArchive@gmail.com.
- **NOTE: Newsletter subscribers** build your Customers list inside Shopify — you can email them later
with Shopify Email or a tool like Mailchimp.